

MZANSI MONEY MATTERS
NEWS · DATA · SPORTS

Project briefer — where we are today

A one-glance status of the site. This file is the source of truth for the branded `mzansi-briefer.pdf` alongside it — edit the lists below, then run `node docs/render-pdfs.mjs` to rebuild the PDF. Last updated: 2026-10-20 · Codename: Genesis 🧬

LIVE & WORKING

New masthead — mobile & desktop
Full-bleed bar with the brand badge (logo + MZANSI MONEY MATTERS + cyan tagline), menu on the left, ✉ Subscribe on the right. Same design language across phone and laptop.

Site-wide search (desktop)
Search icon opens a live filter across news articles, NYSE stocks, top cryptos, calendar events, Substack posts and the pages themselves. Click a result to jump.

Substack integration
Ntokozo's latest 3 posts pull from `ntokozocele.substack.com/feed` (via a Vercel serverless function) and show as a "Ntokozo's take" section on the News page, brand-styled, click-through to Substack. Substack posts also appear in site-wide search tagged "SUBSTACK".

Newsletter signup via Substack
The ✉ Subscribe button on both mobile and desktop links straight to Ntokozo's Substack signup. One list, one place to write from, one place to send campaigns.

Socials + contact
Instagram, X and Facebook icons in the footer + mobile burger menu, plus the `info@mzansimoneymatters.co.za` email as an orange button. Handles live in one file (`src/lib/socials.jsx`) so adding TikTok / LinkedIn / YouTube / WhatsApp later is a one-line edit.

TradingView widgets
The `/jse` page is a real live page (JSE All Share chart + top-10 ticker tape + 9 mini charts + ZA market screener). NYSE and Crypto pages have live TradingView hero charts (S&P 500 and BTCUSD) above their existing content.

Sector Health page
`/sectors` renders weekly JSE sector commentary from Supabase (`sector_summary_public` view). Each card has a color-graded 0–100 health gauge, cycle position, expandable narrative, tailwinds/headwinds bullet lists, and "what to watch next". Data flows client → `/api/sectors` (Vercel serverless function) → Supabase, cached 10 min at edge. Compliance-strict: prominent "educational only, not financial advice" disclaimer at top and bottom; no buy/sell language anywhere.

Live NYSE prices
Alpha Vantage feeds ticker data on the NYSE page. Sample data shows when the daily API quota is used up.

Live crypto data
CoinGecko powers the Crypto page — no key needed, generous free tier.

Economic Calendar (seed data)
26 upcoming global data releases across 8 countries. Ready to swap for a live feed when we pick one.

Home "Today's brief"
Rate-holds top story, JSE/NYSE/BTC snapshot, Economic Calendar peek — the front-page recap of everything.

Prediction Markets page
`/predictions` renders live Polymarket odds on politics, crypto and business events. Server-side filters to those three categories with a keyword blocklist that keeps sports/celebrity/tasteless markets out. Each card shows the leading outcome as a colour-graded probability, the full YES/NO (or top-3 for multi-outcome) split, 24h volume, and a click-out to Polymarket. Same compliance framing as `/sectors` — educational-only banner + "market pricing" language, never "buy/sell". Fills the slot vacated by Soccer Betting.

Analytics & Speed Insights
Vercel Web Analytics + Speed Insights wired into the app root. Cookie-less, POPIA-friendly, no consent banner needed. Owner sees page views / top pages / referrers / real-world Core Web Vitals in the Vercel dashboard.

Legal & Compliance page
`/legal` covers the Financial Disclaimer (not a licensed FSP, data may be delayed/wrong, third-party embeds carry own terms), Terms of Use (permitted/prohibited use, IP, SA governing law), and Privacy Policy (POPIA-aligned — what we collect, what we don't, your rights). Footer's bottom row links to each section. Boilerplate-quality; owner should have a lawyer review before big paid-traffic push.

AI Analyst
`/analyst` lets readers pull a Claude-powered educational breakdown of any JSE / NYSE ticker or top crypto. Backend (`api/analyst.js`) fuses TwelveData quote + FMP company profile + FMP news headlines + CoinGecko (crypto) and hands the whole blob to Claude with a strict system prompt that returns a structured JSON view (snapshot · what the business does · what the numbers suggest · what to watch). Compliance framing throughout — "educational, not advice", never "buy/sell/target price". Deep-link friendly (`/analyst?symbol=AAPL` auto-runs), with a "Share to Facebook" button that posts a pre-filled caption + canonical URL.

Crypto → Analyst routing
Clicking any coin row on the `/crypto` page now jumps to `/analyst?symbol=X` (was previously opening a side-panel modal that readers found unusable). Treats a bug fix as a UX upgrade.

Clickable headlines everywhere
Every news card (home page lead, side, bottom; news page featured, grid) is now always a tappable `<a>`. If the article carries a real source URL it opens that; if it's a sample fallback (shown when the Marketaux API hasn't loaded), it opens a Google News search for the exact headline — so a reader is never stranded on a dead card.

SEO foundation
`public/sitemap.xml` (10 URLs), `public/robots.txt`, Organization + WebSite JSON-LD in `index.html`, per-page `<PageMeta>` with Open Graph + Twitter cards + canonical URLs. Submitted to Google Search Console.

Share-to-Facebook on reports
AI Analyst results and `/sectors` cards carry a one-click "Share to Facebook" button that opens FB's sharer prefilled with an emoji-headed caption + canonical URL — turns a reader into a re-poster in one tap.

Promo videos (marketing)
Three vertical 9:16 motion graphics shipped: 15s brand intro, 30s "Genesis" cut with messaging on investment decision-making + the Mthandeni SK — Gucci ft. MaWhoo track, and a 45s "Kasi to the world" promo for the sibling site `mmm.mzansimoneymatters.online`. Rendered via Playwright + ffmpeg from self-contained HTML templates in `scratchpad/`.

Auto-deploy on Vercel
Every push to main goes live at www.mzansimoneymatters.co.za within a minute.

NOT THERE YET

Deep links from search results
Search jumps to the right page but doesn't scroll to or highlight the exact item. Needs anchor IDs + scrollIntoView.

Search on mobile
Removed to keep the header clean; desktop only for now. A phone-friendly version (icon in the burger menu?) is on the list.

Alpha Vantage rate limit
Free tier is 25 requests/day. On a busy day the NYSE page falls back to sample data. A paid tier or a caching layer fixes it.

Live economic calendar
Currently hard-coded. Trading Economics / FMP would give a live feed but both charge past a small free tier.

Bundle size
>500kb single JS chunk (build warns). Code-splitting per route will speed up first paint on 3G.

Error tracking
We have traffic analytics now (Vercel), but no error / crash tracking (Sentry-style). Not urgent while traffic is small.

Lawyer review of /legal
The legal page is a reasonable-standard template; a real SA attorney should review before any big paid-traffic push (~R1,500–R3,000 for 30 min).

AI Analyst model pin
Anthropic retired the `claude-3-5-sonnet-latest` alias, so the backend is pinned to `claude-3-5-sonnet-20241022` with a `CLAUDE_MODEL` env-var override. If Anthropic retires that dated version too, the Analyst falls over until the env var is bumped — set up a reminder to roll it when a newer Sonnet lands.

Marketaux fallback showing
When Marketaux hasn't loaded (API blip, quota), the home + news pages show the hardcoded sample stories. The new click-fallback (Google News search) means those cards aren't dead, but readers notice the same six headlines repeating. A tiny Vercel KV cache + a "news loading…" skeleton state would feel more alive.

NEXT UP (MY PICKS)

Distribution, not features
Last traffic read was 33 visitors / 7 days with 82% bounce. SEO foundation is in; the site now needs *consumption*. Weekly Substack post + 2–3 promo clips per week (we've got the Playwright-rendered video pipeline) landing on Facebook & X will do more for growth than any new page.

Strategy layer
a lightweight "Ntokozo's rating" per JSE ticker (Watch / Avoid / etc + one-line reason), stored simply and displayed as a branded card next to the TradingView chart on each stock. Ties into Substack articles. This is the real editorial differentiation — the thing nobody else can copy, and it would feed naturally off the AI Analyst's structured output.

FMP for the Calendar
AI Analyst already uses FMP for company profiles + news. Adding FMP's economic calendar endpoint would retire the hardcoded `/calendar` data in a few hours of work (free tier is 250 req/day — more than enough).

Deep-link search results to the exact item (article / ticker / event).